

Andrea jumped in with, “We just believe that’s what God wants us to do, Aunt Maye. But we have a little problem and wondered if you could help.”

“What kind of problem?”

“We’ve had to drive farther than we planned and ran out of cash. I wondered if you would mind cashing a small check for me.”

“I don’t want your check. I’ll be glad to give you some money as a wedding present. But I certainly wish you would think about this some more.”

“We have already thought about it, and we know this is what we want to do,” Andrea said emphatically. Bill started to answer but changed his mind. Then Andrea’s aunt said something that caught them off guard.

“But I don’t understand why you drove all the way up here. New Jersey has a three-day waiting period before you can get married.”

“That can’t be,” Andrea wailed. “The waitress said she got married here herself without a wait.”

“That must have been some time ago then,” her aunt said. “I’ll check for you, but I’m sure that’s right.”

A quick look on the Internet confirmed her statement. “The closest place to get married with no wait is Virginia.”

“That’s impossible,” Bill moaned. “We were just there and someone told us they had a waiting period too.”

Another Internet check confirmed that they could get married without a wait if they were of legal age.

“I suspect the waitress thought you kids were not old enough to get married without permission,” the aunt said. “Looks like you’ll have to drive back to Virginia.”

They decided to sleep a few hours before they headed back, and in the interim Andrea’s aunt washed and dried their well-worn clothes. Four hours later they were back on the road, headed toward Virginia, where they finally found a justice of the peace who could